

Project XTC – Development Edition 0.1

Chapter 9 – Installation and First Connection (Revision 1)

This chapter takes you from an unconfigured X-Touch to a working connection with Bitwig Studio using the DrivenByMoss extension. It also includes the setup details that are easy to miss but can prevent the controller from communicating correctly.

Before You Begin

This chapter assumes:

- Bitwig Studio 6.1 or later
- DrivenByMoss 26.x
- X-Touch firmware 1.22
- A direct USB connection between the X-Touch and your computer

Step 1 – Enter the Startup Configuration

Power on the X-Touch using the appropriate startup button combination to enter the configuration screen. The first display should indicate MC, confirming that the controller is operating in Mackie Control Universal (MCU) mode.

Step 2 – Check the Communication Method

The second scribble strip controls how the X-Touch communicates with the computer. It may display either:

lfc: MIDI
or
lfc: USB

For DrivenByMoss over USB, this must be set to lfc: USB. If necessary, rotate the Channel 2 encoder until USB is shown.

Important – Save the Setting

Changing the display is not enough. After selecting lfc: USB, press the Channel 1 encoder to confirm the change. Only then is the setting written to memory. If you restart the controller without confirming, it will continue using the previous value.

Step 3 – Connect to Bitwig

Once the X-Touch has restarted, connect it to Bitwig using the DrivenByMoss X-Touch controller. When choosing MIDI ports, select:

- Input: X-Touch INT
- Output: X-Touch INT

The X-Touch EXT ports are not normally used with a single X-Touch.

How to Recognise a Healthy Connection

Within a few seconds you should see: Track names on the scribble strips. Motor faders moving to match the current project. The SELECT buttons changing Bitwig's selected track. PLAY, STOP and RECORD controlling the Bitwig transport. If all four occur, communication is working correctly in both directions.

Reality Check

Blank scribble strips immediately after startup do not necessarily indicate a hardware fault. They often mean the X-Touch is waiting for Bitwig to establish communication, or that the startup communication mode was left set to lfc: MIDI instead of lfc: USB.

Troubleshooting Checklist

1. Confirm MCU mode.
2. Confirm lfc: USB in the startup menu.
3. Press the Channel 1 encoder to save any changes.
4. Verify that DrivenByMoss is using X-Touch INT.
5. Use MIDI Monitor if you suspect no data is being transmitted.
6. Restart Bitwig after changing controller settings.

Field Notes

#011 The need to confirm startup settings with the Channel 1 encoder is easy to miss and is not obvious during initial setup.

#012 Seeing lfc: MIDI instead of lfc: USB can leave the controller apparently healthy while preventing normal USB operation with DrivenByMoss.

Key Takeaways

- Use MCU mode.
- Set the second startup display to lfc: USB.
- Always press the Channel 1 encoder to save startup changes.
- Select X-Touch INT for both MIDI input and output.
- Use the scribble strips and motor faders as your first indicators of a successful connection.